Therefore, I decided to parallelly work on a set of 100 major policy reforms (macroeconomic and sectoral) that, in my view, the country required to build an environmentally sustainable $10 trillion economy while banishing poverty in all its dimensions. I made some progress and had a draft ready. My intent was to present it to the finance minister and prime minister once the new government was formed.

My world changed drastically after the new finance minister joined. The changed equation with the political executive after May 2019 impelled me to leave the government and seek to influence policy as a member of the wider society. I continued to work on my 100 policy reforms when I was serving the three months' notice in the Ministry of Power. I did get the opportunity to present my ideas to Prime Minister Narendra Modi in September 2019.

I placed these 100 policy ideas in the public domain in November 2019. I also started writing on the state of economy and policy in India, both in the macro and sectoral contexts. These writings attracted considerable interest with many colleges, academicians, newspapers and journals reprinting and commenting on many of them. I was invited to address several colleges, industry associations and think tanks.

In July 2020, Manish Kumar from Penguin suggested I write a book on the economy and the policies India needs to enter the higher orbits of GDP growth. I found the proposal very interesting as it provided me a vehicle to explain the state of Indian economy and policy besides presenting my ideas in a more organized and coherent manner.

In the book you hold, I present my assessment of the economic policies India has pursued in its seventy-five years as an independent nation, the economy these policies have helped build, and the policies we need to build a $10 trillion economy by 2035. I hope you find the book worth your time.